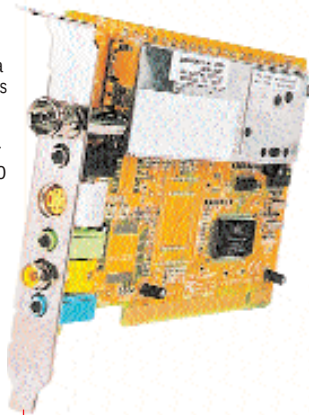
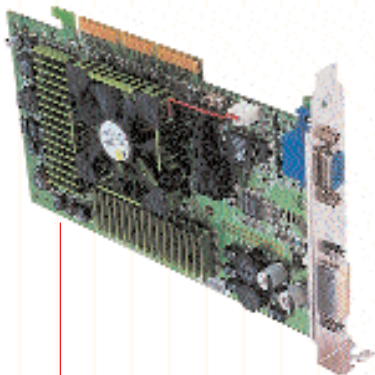
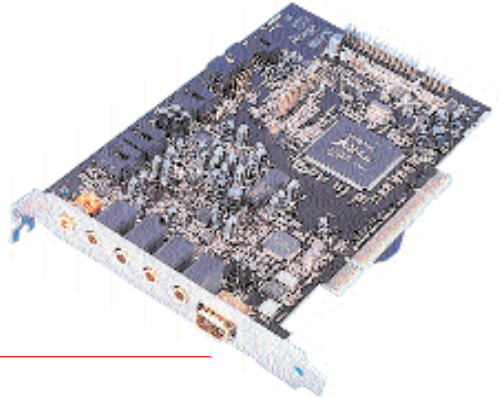


>> Deconstructing your PC TV

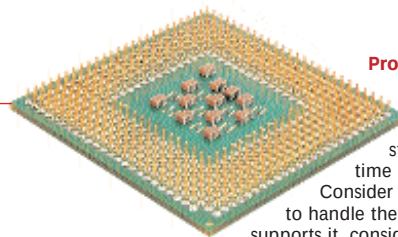
TV tuner: This is probably the most important component you need to get your favourite channel on the PC. Ideally, a card with hardware MPEG-2 compression is recommended, but keeping in mind the price factor, a card without hardware compression will fulfil the need, but if your processor's fast enough. The cost? Rs 2,000 to Rs 4,500.



Sound Card: A good sound card completes a home-surround system. A good one shouldn't cost you more than Rs 3,000.



Graphics card: For a video card that shows full-screen video in true colour, any modern graphics card should do. If you need to upgrade, a Rs 2,500-solution will set you on the path to gorgeous graphics.



Processor: A Media Center PC will work on a 300 MHz processor, but won't be able to cope with the stress generated due to real-time MPEG compression. Consider at least a 1 GHz processor to handle the stress. If your motherboard supports it, consider moving to a 2 GHz processor for Rs 4,500.

Optical drive: With a well-configured audio and video configuration, it stands to reason that you should use the best-quality recorded media. While high-quality DivX and VCDs look great on your Media Center PC, nothing beats the quality of a DVD movie with multi-channel sound. Consider an upgrade to a DVD-combo drive for Rs 3,500.

High-capacity storage: As your Media Center PC will be recording your favourite shows daily, the system should have enough storage space. Since hard disk prices have reached rock bottom, you can consider at least an 80 GB upgrade for Rs 5,000.

Memory: While Windows XP is rumoured to work with 128 MB RAM, 256 MB guarantees smoother video playback and less stressful recordings—a significant boost in performance that costs only Rs 1,000.

Remote Control: Ever thought of a TV without a remote control? Then why should things be different here? Make sure your TV tuner comes bundled with a couch potato's best friend.

